

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 10 9 7 2

♠ 7 6 4

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ A 9 7 2

♣ 8 6



♠ 10 3

♥ A J 9 5 2

♦ J 10 5 4

♣ 5 3

♠ A K Q J 8

♥ K 4

♦ K 3

♣ A K Q 4

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

5♦

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6♠ by South

This is definitely a 2♣ opening bid.

Partner responds 2♦, 7 points or less.

The formalities are over. Partner knows you have 22 or more points and you know he has 7 or fewer. Time to find a suit.

You bid 2♠ which partner raises to 3♠.

Partner's 3♠ bid is forward-going. With a complete bust he would have said 3♣ as a "second negative". So you use Blackwood. Partner shows one Ace and you bid the slam.

South plays 6♠. West leads the ♣J.

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Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Between the ♥ loser and the ♣ loser which one can you eliminate? Easy question, fast losers like the ♥A are tough to eliminate. Usually you work on those slow losers.

The logical way to remove that ♣ loser is to ruff it in dummy. But do it carefully. It would be silly to play ♣A, ♣K, ♣Q and then try to ruff the ♣4. That is just begging for an over-ruff. It would be better to just take two rounds of ♣s, then ruff the ♣4. But even that isn't the best.

First take two rounds of trumps with the ♠A and ♠K. Then play two top ♣s. Only then do you ruff the ♣4.

You only needed one trump in dummy to ruff your one ♣ loser, so that made it right to pull two rounds of trumps first.

It made no difference in tricks whether you ruffed the third or fourth ♣ so that made it right to ruff the third one.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 4
♥ 9 8 7 5 3
♦ A K 10 4
♣ 8

♠ K Q 7 2

♥ J 4

♦ 7 6 2

♣ 6 5 3 2



♠ 5 3

♥ Q 10 6 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ K 9 7 4

♠ A J 8 6

♥ A K

♦ J 9 5

♣ A Q J 10

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Partner has 20-21 points, so with your 6 you belong in game. But which game?

You use Stayman convention to try to find out.

Partner responds 3♠.

You have at least 26 combined points and 8 ♠s. So you bid 4♠.

North would play 4♠.

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South plays 4♠. West leads ♦ A, ♦ K, ♦ 4. East wins the third trick with ♦ Q and plays a ♥.

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Since you've already lost the three ♦s you'd better not lose the ♣.

You must find East with the ♣K and you must be able to finesse three times. That means three dummy entries and they all must come from the trump suit.

Play the ♠A, then lead the ♠8 to dummy's ♠Q. Notice that you must save your ♠6. Pay attention to whether both defenders follow to both tricks. They do, and that means there is only one ♠ left out. Play a ♣ and finesse the ♣10. Now lead the ♠J to dummy's ♠K. Finesse the ♣J. Finally, lead the ♠6 to dummy's ♠7. Finesse the ♣Q. Claim the rest.

This was not an easy plan.

The first part is realizing that you need to have three entries to dummy.

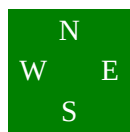
The second part is figuring out that the ♠ suit could provide them.

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ 7
♦ 10 6 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3

♠ 10 7 3
♥ K J 5 4
♦ K 7
♣ A Q 10 6



♠ Q 6 5 4
♥ 9 6
♦ A Q J 9
♣ K 7 2

♠ A 8
♥ A Q 10 8 3 2
♦ 8 4
♣ J 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

If the ♣ finesse works you have no ♣ loser, and as a bonus you will be able to discard one of your other losers. Even if the finesse fails you still have an extra winner for the discard.

Is there a danger here? Yes. Suppose you win the first trick, pull trumps, then finesse the ♣. East might win and play a ♠ back to West's hand. And West might then lead a ♦ through dummy's ♦ K.

West is the Danger Hand. You want to keep him off the lead. His only possible entry is the ♠ suit, so all you have to do is hold up on the first trick. Win the second ♠, pull trumps as before, and finesse the ♣. East wins but cannot get to his partner's hand for the killing ♦ lead. You will discard one of your ♦ losers on dummy's fourth ♣.

You usually think of a hold-up play in a Notrump contract, trying to exhaust one defender of his partner's suit.

For this deal the hold-up serves a different purpose. It keeps one defender from ever gaining the lead.

You had to lose one ♠ in any case, so you just choose to lose it to the defender who cannot hurt you.

Notice that the Danger Hand **WAS** on lead at one point - the opening lead. If West had been clairvoyant enough to lead a ♦ the contract could have been beaten. Opening leads are important to the defense.

Don't even think of jumping to 2♥. That would show 17+ points. Instead you just bid 1♥, knowing partner is forced to bid again.

Partner does bid again, saying 2♥.

Partner's rebid promises a minimum opening bid (13-15) and four ♥s. That makes your total about 28 points and ten ♥s. So you bid game.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠ 2, East playing the ♠ Q.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4